

Me: Hello. So, before we start, is it okay if I record this interview and use the transcript for our project research?

Interviewee: Oh, yeah, I'm okay.

Me: Okay, then can you tell me a little bit about your current living situation? And who do you usually share the kitchen with?

Interviewee: Oh, I'm from Taiwan and I'm studying, and I'm in New Year 2, and I live with four other roommates, which is from Thailand.

Me: Okay.

Me: So, for the first question, thinking about your current shared accommodation, can you walk me through the last time you and your housemates were actually in the kitchen cooking a meal together?

Interviewee: Oh, we're trying to make some Taiwanese dishes, like tomato and eggs and some fried rice. And I think the most chaotic part was the kitchen itself. Like, we only have one decent flying pan and a electronic stove where we can only have two hot plates that actually work. And someone forget to press the button on the rice cooker. So the food was getting cold when we. So we wait for the rice and we keep bumping into each other. Like when we try to wash the pan between the tiny sink. Yeah,.

Me: Okay, so for the second question, when multiple people are preparing a single shared dish, how do you keep track of who is supposed to do what?

Interviewee: Oh, I think there's no real system for us, but there must be someone who is the most familiar one with the dish. So, like, he will be the head chef, I guess, and everyone. Everyone else will just stands around to wait to be told to wash, like, the dishes or peels garlic or something. So we will just stress out the person who is trying to actually cook. So, yeah.

Me: Okay, so for the third question, have you ever had a moment where trying to share one recipe screen or just yelling out instructions caused a mistake or issue in the kitchen?

Interviewee: Oh yes. We were watching a Taiwanese cooking channel on YouTube to make the three cup chicken and that time my hand was covered in soy sauce and sesame oil and the screen was locked so I couldn't touch it and we missed the exact timing for adding the garlic sauce. So we were kind of yelling at each other and we quickly wash our hands to unlock the phone before the pan starts smoking and heating.

Me: Okay, so for the fourth question, when you are all cooking together, how do you divide up the physical effort, like chopping, using the stove, or cleaning?

Interviewee: Oh, I think we are pretty random. Like, one person always gets stuck doing the really annoying task, like peeling a mountain of garlic or like washing the veggies one by one, and while the other person will just get to do the fun part, which is actually cooking the food.

Me: Okay, so for the fifth question, do you ever feel like the physical work ends up being unbalanced because it's hard to organize in the moment?

Interviewee: Yeah, definitely, because I'm always the one who know all the recipe, so I'm doing 90% of the work. And my housemate will just send out some bowls and chopsticks, and they will sit at the table to wait to eat. And it feel like I'm running a restaurant instead with. Instead of cooking with them.

Me: Damn, bro. For the next part. Based on all the frustrations we just talked about, what would actually make it easier for you and your housemates to cook together more often?

Interviewee: I think if everyone knew the plan of us, like, we didn't have to constantly ask each other what to do next just to have a clean division of labor, like, who will wash the rice, who will mince the ginger, or who will watch over the stove. So we will not, like, interrupt each other.

Me: Okay. Okay, so for the last question, if you have, like, a tool or, like, something to solve that specific problem of coordinating who does what in the kitchen, how would you want it to work?

Interviewee: Probably I want an app on my phone. Like, we can join a session. Like, I look up my phone, and it will give me a checklist of some specific preparation tasks while their phone will give their task to them, and then we can physically split up. Like, I can chop stuff, and they can use the stove. And my. I hope that my phone will, like, ring when it is time to bring the place over, so we won't be fighting for, like, for the same place.

Me: Okay. Thank you so much.